

MGTP 425: Professional Research for Accountants

Session: FALL 2026

Course Day/Time: M, 9:00am-11:50 am

Course Meeting Dates: Weeks 1-5 (September 28 – October 30)

Instructor: Andrew Jeter, J.D.

Email: anjeter@ucsd.edu

Office Hours: M 12pm-1pm (after class) and virtual (by appointment)

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This accelerated 2-unit course meets California State Board of Accountancy requirements for focused instruction in accounting and tax research. Students will learn to locate, interpret, and apply authoritative guidance from sources such as the FASB Codification, Internal Revenue Code, PCAOB/AICPA standards, and SEC releases, using professional research platforms including Thomas Reuters Checkpoint Edge and CCH IntelliConnect. The course emphasizes the IRAC (Issue, Rule, Application, Conclusion) framework, professional memo writing, and case-based exercises. Students will also explore the emerging role of artificial intelligence and data analytics in research, preparing them for the evolving demands of the accounting profession.

OBJECTIVES

By the close of this course, you will be able to:

- Identify and clearly articulate researchable accounting, auditing, and tax issues.
- Distinguish between authoritative and nonauthoritative research sources.
- Navigate and search the FASB Accounting Standards Codification efficiently.
- Locate and apply relevant PCAOB and AICPA auditing standards.
- Conduct tax research using primary and secondary tax authorities and professional research databases.
- Apply a systematic professional research process to unfamiliar fact patterns.
- Analyze authoritative guidance rather than merely locating relevant citations.
- Draft concise professional research memoranda that clearly present issues, authority, analysis, and conclusions.
- Evaluate appropriate and inappropriate uses of artificial intelligence in professional accounting research.

REQUIRED MATERIALS

Textbook: *Skills for Accounting Research* 5thth Edition) by Shelby Collins

- ISBN-13: 978-618-53571-9 (print) | ISBN-13: 978-1-618-53594-8 (eTextbook).

Students will also require access to:

- FASB Accounting Standards Codification
- Thomson Reuters Checkpoint Edge
- CCH IntelliConnect or equivalent tax research resources
- PCAOB standards and related professional guidance
- AICPA professional standards and related resource
- Additional instructor-provided readings, cases, and AI materials

COURSE SCHEDULE

A detailed schedule with weekly assignments, additional readings, case studies, and other course materials will be posted and updated on the course Canvas site. Students are responsible for checking Canvas regularly to stay current with course requirements as the schedule may change based on pace of instruction, student requests and evolving industry trends.

Date	Class Topics	Chapters Covered
Week 1	Course Overview: <i>Introduction to course topics, structure and expectations.</i> Professional Accounting Research & The FASB Codification: <i>Research fundamentals; FASB Codification and search strategies</i>	Ch. 1 – Overview of Accounting Research Ch. 2 – FASB Codification: Introduction & Search Strategies Ch. 3 – Research Process
Week 2	The FASB Codification + Research Process & Professional Memo Writing: <i>Applying authoritative guidance; IRAC and memo documentation</i>	Ch. 3 – Research Process Ch. 4 – Creating Effective Documentation Ch. 5 – Nonauthoritative Sources
Week 3	Audit & Professional Services Research: <i>PCAOB/AICPA standards and authoritative audit research</i>	Ch. 9 – Audit and Professional Services Research
Week 4	Tax Research & Professional Databases: <i>Tax authority; Thomson Reuters Checkpoint Edge and CCH IntelliConnect</i>	Ch. 11 – Fundamentals of Tax Research
Week 5	Evolving Trends & Course Integration: <i>Artificial intelligence, current guidance, and final research application</i>	Ch. 14 – Staying Current with Emerging Guidance Additional Reading TBA

ASSIGNMENTS

Students will complete a series of weekly assignments designed to reinforce research concepts and professional communication skills. Assignments may include research exercises, short written memos, case analyses, and database practice. These tasks will provide hands-on experience with tools such as the FASB Codification, RIA Checkpoint, and CCH IntelliConnect, while also emphasizing the IRAC framework and professional writing standards.

All assignments will be posted on the course Canvas site. Due dates and submission details will be provided with each assignment.

Reading Assignments

Students are encouraged to complete the assigned textbook chapters listed in the weekly schedule prior to each class meeting. Doing so will help maximize understanding of the material and allow for more meaningful participation in discussions, case studies, and in-class exercises.

Class Participation, Attendance, Quizzes and Daily Assignments

To encourage preparation, participation, and attendance, open-book quizzes and assignments may be given during class sessions. These quizzes and assignments will be based on the assigned readings and in-class discussions and are intended to reinforce key concepts rather than test rote memorization.

GRADING

Assignments	Points [or percentage]
Weekly Assignments	40%
In-Class Participation, Exercises & Quizzes	20%
Final Research Memo	40%
Total	100%

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (AI) POLICY

This course will actively explore the role of artificial intelligence (AI) tools, including large language models (LLMs), in accounting research. Students are encouraged to experiment with AI methods as supplemental aids to enhance efficiency and explore emerging trends. However, authoritative sources—such as the FASB Codification, PCAOB and AICPA standards, Internal Revenue Code, and SEC releases—must always serve as the foundation for research assignments, memos, and case analyses.

Permitted Use: Students may use AI tools to the extent discussed in course readings and lectures, with a focus on understanding how AI can complement but not replace authoritative research.

Disclosure Requirement: Any use of AI in assignments must be clearly disclosed in a short note (e.g., “AI was used to generate an outline for this memo; authoritative citations and analysis are my own”).

Limitations: AI tools are known to produce errors or fabrications. Students are responsible for verifying all information against authoritative sources.

Academic Integrity: Failure to disclose AI use, or submitting AI-generated work without proper verification and citation of authoritative sources, may be considered a violation of academic integrity standards.

This policy is consistent with UC San Diego’s guidance: AI may be used for support, but students are expected to complete their own work, demonstrate independent analysis, and ensure the accuracy of all submissions.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Integrity of scholarship is essential for an academic community. As members of the Rady School, we pledge ourselves to uphold the highest ethical standards. The University expects that both faculty and students will honor this principle and in so doing protect the validity of University intellectual work. For students, this means that all academic work will be done by the individual to whom it is assigned, without unauthorized aid of any kind. The complete UCSD Policy on Integrity of Scholarship can be viewed at: <http://senate.ucsd.edu/Operating-Procedures/Senate-Manual/Appendices/2>

STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

A student who has a disability or special need and requires an accommodation in order to have equal access to the classroom must register with the Office for Students with Disabilities (OSD). The OSD will determine what accommodations may be made and provide the necessary documentation to present to the faculty member.

The student must present the OSD letter of certification and OSD accommodation recommendation to the appropriate faculty member in order to initiate the request for accommodation in classes, examinations, or other academic program activities. **No accommodations can be implemented retroactively.**

Please visit the [OSD website](#) for further information or contact the Office for Students with Disabilities at (858) 534-4382 or osd@ucsd.edu.